

GLOSSARY

ADJACENT COLORS Those colors literally closest to each other on the color wheel; also used to describe colors that lie next to one another in a painting. Adjacent complementary colors appear brighter together because each reinforces the effect of the other.

ADVANCING COLOR The perception of a color, usually warm (orange-red), as being close to the viewer.

AERIAL PERSPECTIVE This describes the effect of atmospheric conditions on our perception of the tone and color of distant objects. As objects recede toward the horizon they appear lighter in tone and more blue due to the scattering of light in the atmosphere. Artists tend to use a cool color such as blue to paint objects viewed in the distance to achieve a sense of space. Some artists like to work from the palest tones through to the darkest tones in the foreground to create distance and depth. This principle is used particularly in landscape painting.

ALLA PRIMA Literally means "at first" and is a direct form of painting made in one session or while the colors remain wet. (As opposed to "indirect" painting in which the painting is built up in layers). This is the technique employed by artists when they want to paint spontaneously. It is, however,

a difficult style to master as it requires fluent brushstrokes and a skillful manipulation of the paint.

BINDER In a paint, this is the substance that holds the pigment particles together and that acts as an adhesive to the support (*see also* extender).

BLENDING A soft, gradual transition from one color or tone to another. A clean, dry brush should be used to make gentle strokes in the same direction to join separate colors. Blending may involve slightly softening the sharp outline of a single object against a background, or working on the whole painting, so that it takes on a rounded, seemingly three-dimensional effect.

BRISTLE BRUSHES Hog hair or bristle brushes are used extensively in oil painting. They have coarse hairs which hold plenty of thick paint and yet retain their shape. Bristle brushes are useful for covering large areas with a uniform tone and for blending.

BROKEN COLOR Color that has been broken up by mixing with another color or affected optically by the juxtaposition or superimposition of another color. Broken color can be created using a dry brush or scumbling technique.

CHALK Natural calcium carbonate, used in the preparation of chalk/glue grounds for its whiteness and opacity and as a cheap extender in oil-based paints in which it is translucent. "Chalking" is the powdering of the paint surface due to the breakdown of the binder as a result of ultraviolet radiation.

CHARCOAL Carbonized wood made by charring willow, vine, or other twigs in airtight containers. Charcoal is one of the oldest drawing materials. If charcoal is used for a preparatory drawing, the excess dust can be rubbed off the surface using a large soft hair brush or a piece of doughy bread.

CHROMA The intensity or saturation of a color. Chromatic is the term used for an image that has been drawn or painted in a range of different colors.

COLOR TEMPERATURE A measurement of color in degrees Kelvin. This is also of importance to photographers, who need to correlate the color temperature of a light source with the type of film they use. As artists we are aware that the color temperature of a room illuminated by electric light is significantly different from (warmer than) that of daylight.

COMPLEMENTARY COLOR Two colors of maximum contrast opposite each other on the color wheel. The complementary of a primary color is the combination of the two remaining primary colors. For example, the complementary of blue is orange-red, the opposite of red is green, and the complement of yellow is violet.

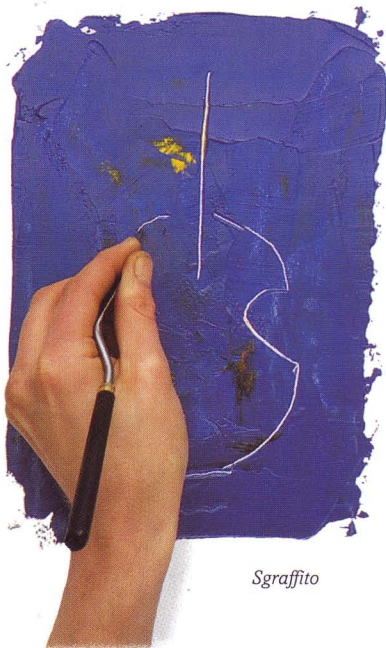
COOL COLOR Generally, a color such as blue is considered cool. Distant colors appear bluer due to atmospheric effects, so cool colors are therefore said to recede.

DAMMAR A soft resin soluble in turpentine and used to make a gloss varnish. You can make an acceptable varnish by dissolving some dammar resin in a jar of turpentine or white spirit.

DARKS Those parts of a painting that are in shadow.

DIRECT PAINTING *See* alla prima.

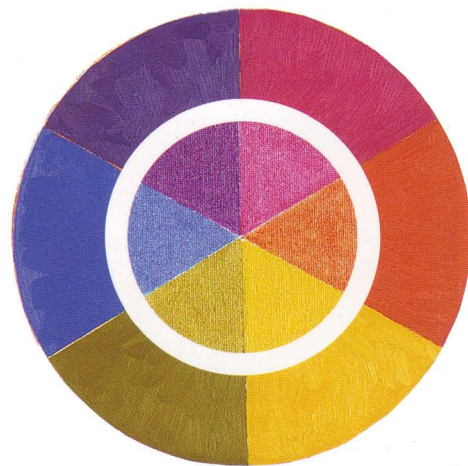
DRAGGED Describes brushstrokes that are made across the textured surface of canvas or paint or at a shallow angle into wet paint.



Sgraffito



Drawing grid



Color wheel